



Pixel 6a India launch

Google is expected to launch the Google Pixel 6a in India by March 2022.

<https://digit.in/jan22-35>



Sodium-ion solar generators

The world's first sodium-ion solar generators debuted at CES 2022.

<https://digit.in/jan22-36>

predecessors. Now, as per the HDMI standards body, all those features are deemed optional. So, every manufacturer under the sun can relabel their HDMI 2.0 products as HDMI 2.1 and consumers would end up buying the higher standard for a premium. Only to realise later on that they've got none of the features that were defined in the new HDMI 2.1 standard. So features such as:

- FRL (Fixed Rate Link) - Responsible for higher bandwidths (OPTIONAL)
- VRR (Variable Refresh Rate)

- For avoiding frame tearing (OPTIONAL)

- ALLM (Auto Low Latency Mode) - For reducing input lag (OPTIONAL)
- Everything under HDMI 2.1 standard (OPTIONAL)

Manufacturers are now required to only mention HDMI 2.1 as the interface and avoid all mentions of HDMI 2.0. So, how does a customer figure out what HDMI features they can use on the new TV that they're about to buy? By trusting the marketing mambo-jumbo of the TV

manufacturer. And we all know how that will pan out.

Display manufacturers are expected to be transparent about the HDMI 2.1 features that they support. So, if you're buying a TV, you'll have to read the fine print which is purposefully hidden from plain sight, and then you have to understand what each technical term means. This has to be compared against the HDMI 2.1 features of the device that is going to be connected to the TV such as a gaming console or a media player. Does that sound fun to you?

BUYING ADVICE

LAPTOP FOR WORK

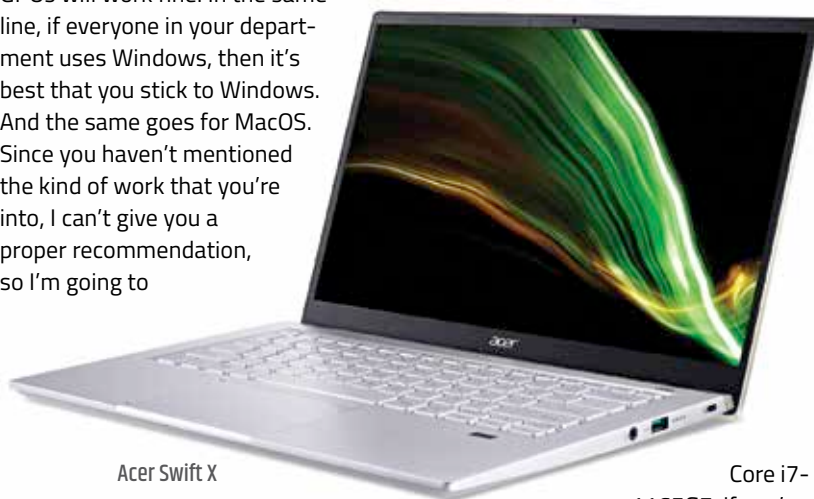
Q Hey Agent001, my company is giving us ₹65K to purchase a laptop. I'm thinking about adding some extra money from my own pocket and getting a decent laptop for work. I've already got a desktop PC that I use for gaming so I don't need the laptop to be for gaming. Although, a little bit of gaming is always going to happen. I'm willing to increase the budget to approximately ₹90K-1 lakh. Should I go for a 2-in-1 laptop or an ultrathin notebook or should I ditch Windows and go for a Macbook?

-Sid

A Hey Sid, I'd ideally recommend understanding the software ecosystems that your company is currently invested in while considering options for your purchase. For example, if you are in the media creation industry and colour accuracy is an important aspect, then you need a calibrated display which comes closest to the colours being used in your line of work. Similarly, if your entire company is using software that uses GPU acceleration and the APIs are proprietary, then you will have to

opt for a laptop which has the appropriate GPU. So, if your work software uses CUDA, you'll need NVIDIA hardware. But if it uses OpenCL, then either NVIDIA or AMD GPUs will work fine. In the same line, if everyone in your department uses Windows, then it's best that you stick to Windows. And the same goes for MacOS. Since you haven't mentioned the kind of work that you're into, I can't give you a proper recommendation, so I'm going to

If you need to get a PC, then check out the Acer Swift X laptops which come with AMD Ryzen 5 5600U and NVIDIA RTX 3050 graphics. There's also the Swift 5 with the Intel



Acer Swift X

Core i7-1165G7, if you're a

make a few assumptions and work out the recommendations.

If you need to get an Apple device then you only have the option of picking the MacBook Air. The MacBook Pro starts at ₹1.3 lakhs so you'll need to double your budget if you want to get the base Pro model. The one with the Apple M1 chips are just as good, if not better than the Intel CPU-based laptops for media creation workloads. Again, your budget can only accommodate the base model which is very good to begin with.

Team Blue fan. The downside is that this one does not come with a discrete GPU. There's also the Zenbook 13 OLED laptops from ASUS which have really impressive displays, if a good display panel is higher on your priority. Right now, the models will either offer you an AMD Ryzen 7 5800U or Intel 11th Gen Core i7-1165G7 as the processor. Both are great, except AMD has the better integrated graphics. All laptops mentioned here are in the ₹85-95K price range and I hope you find one that's to your liking.